



FOR OFFICIAL USE

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National  
Qualifications  
2024

Mark

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**X816/76/01**

**Computing Science**

MONDAY, 20 MAY

1:00 PM – 3:00 PM



Fill in these boxes and read what is printed below.

Full name of centre

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Town

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Forename(s)

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Surname

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Number of seat

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Date of birth

Day

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Month

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Scottish candidate number

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**Total marks — 80**

**SECTION 1 — Software design and development, and Computer systems — 55 marks**

Attempt ALL questions.

**Attempt either Section 2 OR Section 3**

**SECTION 2 — Database design and development — 25 marks**

**SECTION 3 — Web design and development — 25 marks**

**You may use a calculator.**

Show all workings.

Write your answers clearly in the spaces provided in this booklet. Additional space for answers is provided at the end of this booklet. If you use this space you must clearly identify the question number you are attempting.

Use **blue** or **black** ink.

Before leaving the examination room you must give this booklet to the Invigilator; if you do not, you may lose all the marks for this paper.



**SECTION 1 — SOFTWARE DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT, AND COMPUTER SYSTEMS**  
— 55 marks

**Attempt ALL questions**

1. (a) Convert the following denary number to an 8-bit two's complement number.

–25

1

- (b) State the largest positive integer that can be represented using 8-bit two's complement.

1

2. Describe how evaluation differs when developing software using an agile methodology compared to an iterative methodology.

2



3. (a) Convert the binary number below into floating-point representation.

-0.111

There are 16 bits for the mantissa (including the sign bit) and 8 bits for the exponent.

*Space for working*

3

| sign | mantissa | exponent |
|------|----------|----------|
|      |          |          |

- (b) State the effect on the representation of floating-point numbers of increasing the number of bits used to represent the exponent.

1

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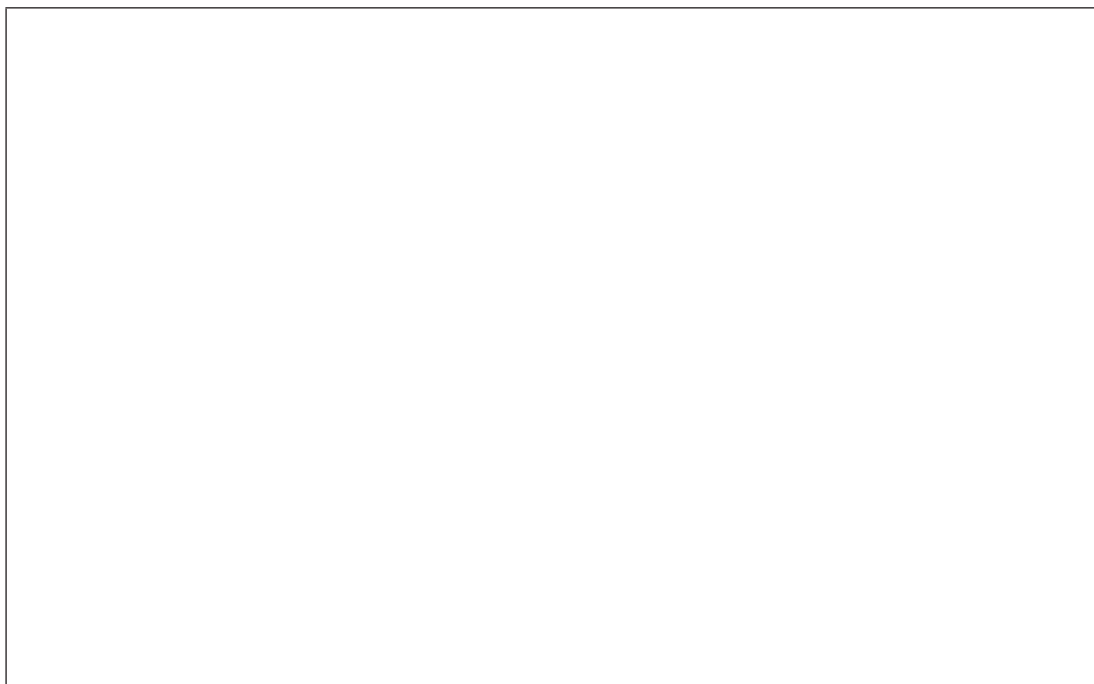
[Turn over



4. An array `surnames` contains a list of surnames.

Using a design technique of your choice, design an algorithm to find the number of characters in the longest surname.

4



5. Computer performance is improved by the inclusion of cache memory on the same computer chip as the processor.

Describe how cache memory improves performance.

2

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6. A prime number is only divisible by one and itself. The first five prime numbers are shown below:

2, 3, 5, 7, 11, ...

The code below checks if a number is prime.

```

Line 1  FUNCTION checkPrime(INTEGER n) RETURNS BOOLEAN
Line 2      DECLARE validPrime INITIALLY TRUE
Line 3      IF n < 2 THEN
Line 4          SET validPrime TO FALSE
Line 5      ELSE
Line 6          FOR divisor FROM 2 TO (n-1) DO
Line 7              IF <the remainder of n divided by divisor is
                  equal to 0> THEN
Line 8                  SET validPrime TO FALSE
Line 9              END IF
Line 10         END FOR
Line 11     RETURN validPrime
Line 12 END FUNCTION
...
Line 42 DECLARE inputNum AS INTEGER INITIALLY FROM KEYBOARD
Line 43 <set isPrime by calling the function checkPrime to
        identify if inputNum is prime or not>
Line 44 IF isPrime = TRUE THEN
Line 45     SEND inputNum & " is prime." TO DISPLAY
Line 46 ELSE
Line 47     SEND inputNum & " is not prime." TO DISPLAY
Line 48 END IF

```

- (a) Using a programming language of your choice, write the code for line 7.

2

- (b) Using a programming language of your choice, write the code for line 43.

2



\* X 8 1 6 7 6 0 1 0 5 \*

7. Recipe Finder is an app which allows users to search a list of stored recipes and displays the matching recipes.

The app stores the following details about each recipe:

- recipe title
- main ingredient
- cooking time (in minutes)
- cost per portion
- average rating (out of 5).

The app uses the record data structure shown below for the recipe data.

```
RECORD Recipe IS {STRING title, STRING ingredient,
                  INTEGER minutes, REAL cost, REAL avgRating}
```

- (a) Using a programming language of your choice, declare a variable that can store the data for 750 recipes.

Your answer should include the record data structure defined above.

2



7. (continued)

- (b) Users want to search for recipes by entering the main ingredient and the maximum cooking time (in minutes). The titles and cooking times of any matching recipes should be displayed. For example:

Inputs:

Main ingredient: Pasta

Maximum cooking time: 60

Output:

Lasagne requiring 45 minutes.

Macaroni Cheese requiring 25 minutes.

...

If no recipes match the criteria the following message is displayed.

‘No matches found.’

Using a programming language of your choice, write the code to display this information. Your answer should use the record data structure provided.

6



8. A program should generate a list of unique random integers between a lower and upper limit as chosen by the user.

MARKS  
DO NOT  
WRITE IN  
THIS  
MARGIN

|                            |                                               |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Enter the number of values | <input type="text" value="7"/>                |
| Enter the minimum value    | <input type="text" value="0"/>                |
| Enter the maximum value    | <input type="text" value="20"/>               |
| The values are             | <input type="text" value="1,5,7,9,13,15,19"/> |

- (a) Identify two boundaries of this problem.

2

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The function `validNum` is used to check if a number is already present in the array or not.

When the code is tested an error is found.

```
...
Line 34  FUNCTION validNum(INTEGER randomNum,
                        ARRAY OF INTEGER values) RETURNS BOOLEAN
Line 35      DECLARE valid INITIALLY FALSE
Line 36      FOR index FROM 0 TO length(values) - 1 DO
Line 37          IF values[index] = randomNum THEN
Line 38              SET valid TO FALSE
Line 39          END IF
Line 40      END FOR
Line 41      RETURN valid
Line 42  END FUNCTION
...
Line 63  DECLARE randomList as ARRAY OF INTEGER
        INITIALLY [0] * <size of array>
Line 64  FOR index FROM 0 TO length(randomList) - 1 DO
Line 65      randomVal = <random number between minimum value
                    and maximum value>
Line 66      WHILE validNum(randomVal,randomList) = FALSE
Line 67          randomVal = <random number between minimum value
                    and maximum value>
Line 68      END WHILE
Line 69      SET randomList[index] TO randomVal
Line 70  END FOR
...
```



\* X 8 1 6 7 6 0 1 0 8 \*



8. (continued)

(b) The error is found to be in the function `validNum` shown in lines 34 to 42.

(i) Identify the error in the function.

1

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(ii) Describe the effect of this error when lines 63 to 70 are executed.

2

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(c) The error has been corrected and the code now executes as expected.

Describe how the `validNum` function could be made more efficient.

2

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(d) Formal and actual parameters are used in the code.

Identify a formal parameter for the `validNum` function and its associated actual parameter.

2

Formal parameter \_\_\_\_\_

Actual parameter \_\_\_\_\_

[Turn over



9. An insurance company requires that a black box is installed in an insured car to store data about each journey.

**MARKS** DO NOT  
WRITE IN  
THIS  
MARGIN

The black box records data for each journey including:

- date of travel
- distance travelled in miles
- time spent driving in hours (for example 1 hour 15 minutes is stored as 1.25).

A sample of the data is shown below.

09/03/2024, 40.25, 1.25

04/04/2024, 5.12, 0.17

04/04/2024, 5.12, 0.21

...

A program is written to analyse this data.

The top-level design for the program is shown below.

1. Read the data from a text file into parallel 1D arrays.
2. Calculate the average speed for each individual journey by dividing the distance for that journey by the time taken for that journey.
3. Calculate the average distance travelled for journeys longer than one hour.
4. Write the average speed of all journeys that have a greater distance than the average distance to a file.

- (a) Complete the table below to show the missing data flow for steps 2, 3 and 4.

4

| Step | IN/OUT | Data flow                         |
|------|--------|-----------------------------------|
| 1    | IN     |                                   |
|      | OUT    | date[], distance[], drivingTime[] |
| 2    | IN     |                                   |
|      | OUT    |                                   |
| 3    | IN     |                                   |
|      | OUT    | avgDistance                       |
| 4    | IN     |                                   |
|      | OUT    |                                   |



9. (continued)

- (b) Explain how the data flow identified at the design stage would assist the programmer when implementing the code for the program.

1

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- (c) Step 3 calculates the average distance for journeys longer than one hour. Using a design technique of your choice, design an algorithm for step 3.

4



9. (continued)

(d) The company has been the target of a Denial of Service (DOS) attack involving resource starvation.

(i) Describe what is meant by a resource starvation DOS attack.

1

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(ii) State one cost to the company as a result of a DOS attack.

1

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[Turn over for next question

DO NOT WRITE ON THIS PAGE



10. Lewis uses a smart watch to track the distance he walks each day for a week. His target is to walk 5 kilometres or more each day.

The program will find the highest the number of consecutive days Lewis meets this target.

For example, if the data was 5.2, 4.2, 4.0, 4.8, 5.8, 5.2, 6.4

The expected output should be 3.

The following code has been developed to find the highest number of consecutive days Lewis has met his target but there is an error.

...

```
Line 09  FUNCTION consecutiveDays (ARRAY OF REAL values)
          RETURNS INTEGER
Line 10      DECLARE counter INITIALLY 0
Line 11      DECLARE longestStreak INITIALLY - 1
Line 12      FOR index FROM 0 TO LENGTH(values) - 1 DO
Line 13          SET counter TO 0
Line 14          IF values[index] >= 5.0 THEN
Line 15              SET counter TO counter + 1
Line 16          ELSE
Line 17              IF counter > longestStreak THEN
Line 18                  SET longestStreak TO counter
Line 19              END IF
Line 20              SET counter TO 0
Line 21          END IF
Line 22      END FOR
Line 23      IF counter > longestStreak THEN
Line 24          SET longestStreak TO counter
Line 25      END IF
Line 26      RETURN longestStreak
Line 27  END FUNCTION
...
Line 46  SET distances TO [5.2, 4.2, 4.0, 4.8, 5.8, 5.2, 6.4]
Line 47  SET daysMet TO consecutiveDays(distances)
...
```



\* X 8 1 6 7 6 0 1 1 4 \*

10. (continued)

MARKS DO NOT WRITE IN THIS MARGIN

- (a) Complete the trace table for the first two iterations of the loop.

The trace table should indicate the line number where a variable changes value and the new value of that variable.

3

| Line number | counter | index | longestStreak |
|-------------|---------|-------|---------------|
| 10          | 0       |       |               |
| 11          |         |       | -1            |
| 12          |         | 0     |               |
| 13          | 0       |       |               |
| 15          |         |       |               |
| 12          |         |       |               |
| 13          |         |       |               |
| 18          |         |       |               |
| 20          |         |       |               |

- (b) State the line number of the code that should be removed to correct the algorithm.

1

\_\_\_\_\_

- (c) Name and describe a debugging technique that could be used during execution of the code.

2

\_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_

- (d) Explain why the scope of the variable `counter` is local.

1

\_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_



10. (continued)

- (e) Describe how modular programming increases the efficiency and maintainability of the code.

2

Efficiency \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Maintainability \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

[END OF SECTION 1]





**SECTION 2 — DATABASE DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT — 25 marks**

**Attempt ALL questions**

**11.** A gym would like to make use of a relational database.

(a) Some of the end-user requirements described by the gym staff are to find and display the:

- number of classes run by each instructor
- name of the member who attends the most classes
- name and address of any member who attends more than five classes per week
- total cost of all the classes attended by a member.

(i) Using the end-user requirements above, identify one functional requirement of the relational database.

**1**

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(ii) State an aggregate function that would be needed when implementing the functional requirement identified in part (i) above.

**1**

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**[Turn over**



11. (continued)

(b) The following sample data shows:

- instructors and the classes that they run
- members and the classes that they attend.

| Instructor | Class  |
|------------|--------|
| Ins1       | Class1 |
| Ins2       | Class4 |
| Ins3       | Class2 |
| Ins3       | Class3 |

| Member | Class  |
|--------|--------|
| Mem1   | Class2 |
| Mem2   | Class2 |
| Mem3   | Class1 |
| Mem1   | Class3 |
| Mem2   | Class4 |

Using this sample data, complete an entity-occurrence diagram. Your diagram should include the:

- name of the entities
- instances for each entity
- association between these instances.

2



12. An e-sports club runs weekly tournaments. The club uses three linked tables in a relational database to store details of players, tournaments and scores as shown below.

| Player          | Tournament          | Score                |
|-----------------|---------------------|----------------------|
| <u>playerID</u> | <u>tournamentID</u> | <u>playerID*</u>     |
| forename        | title               | <u>tournamentID*</u> |
| surname         | date                | score                |
| email           |                     |                      |

The following SQL statement has been written to add a new score to the `Score` table.

```
INSERT INTO Score(playerID,score)
VALUES ("P1815", 550);
```

The `tournamentID` field is missing from the SQL statement.

Explain why this causes the SQL statement to fail.

2

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[Turn over



13. A relational database is used to store details of items for sale in a fruit and vegetable shop and of the shop's suppliers in linked tables.

Sample data from two tables is shown below.

| Item   |                 |       |             |              |          |             |
|--------|-----------------|-------|-------------|--------------|----------|-------------|
| itemID | itemName        | type  | buyingPrice | sellingPrice | quantity | supplierRef |
| 145    | Gala apples     | Fruit | 0.40        | 0.44         | 60       | F96         |
| 146    | Iceberg lettuce | Veg   | 0.52        | 0.60         | 45       | F216        |
| 147    | Satsuma         | Fruit | 0.30        | 0.37         | 52       | W125P       |
| 148    | Red pepper      | Veg   | 0.48        | 0.50         | 76       | F216        |
| 149    | Organic banana  | Fruit | 0.17        | 0.23         | 104      | W984        |
| 150    | Cauliflower     | Veg   | 0.93        | 0.95         | 34       | F216        |
| 151    | Orange          | Fruit | 0.85        | 0.89         | 23       | W87         |
| ...    | ...             | ...   | ...         | ...          | ...      | ...         |

| Supplier    |                |                    |
|-------------|----------------|--------------------|
| supplierRef | supplierName   | address            |
| W87         | FV Wholesale   | 136 Main Street    |
| F216        | Sunnybank      | Sunnybank Road     |
| P1982       | J Barrow       | 96 Hillview Street |
| W984        | Fruit Direct   | 26 Glasgow Road    |
| F1982       | Appletree Farm | Appletree Way      |
| F96         | Smyth's Farm   | Drovers Brae       |
| W125P       | M White        | 42 Nevis Crescent  |
| ...         | ...            | ...                |



13. (continued)

- (a) The number of oranges in stock has increased by 20.

Write the SQL statement for a single query which would correctly change the quantity of oranges.

2

- (b) Previously, the shop sold items supplied by private sellers. The shop has now decided to only sell items supplied by local farmers or wholesalers.

The `supplierRef` of private sellers start with the letter P.

Write an SQL statement to remove the details of all private sellers from the database.

2

[Turn over



13. (continued)

- (c) The profit that an item makes is calculated by subtracting the price the item is bought for from the price that the item sells for.

The shop would like to know the largest profit for fruits and vegetables. The largest profit should be listed first. The expected output is shown below.

| type  | Profit |
|-------|--------|
| Veg   | 0.08   |
| Fruit | 0.07   |

Design the SQL statement to produce this output.

4

|                             |  |
|-----------------------------|--|
| Field(s) and calculation(s) |  |
| Table(s)                    |  |
| Search criteria             |  |
| Grouping                    |  |
| Sort order                  |  |



14. A driving school uses a relational database to store details of driving instructors, pupils and bookings in three linked tables.

The relational database uses the following three tables.

| Instructor                                          | Pupil                                      | Booking                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <u>instructorID</u><br>name<br>dayOff<br>hourlyRate | <u>pupilRef</u><br>name<br>address<br>town | <u>bookingNo</u><br>instructorID*<br>pupilRef*<br>date<br>time<br>duration |

- (a) The driving school would like a list of the names of all the instructors who have an hourly rate of more than £35 and the names of all their pupils.

Complete the SQL statement below to produce this list.

3

```
SELECT Instructor.name AS [Instructor], Pupil.name AS
[Pupil]
```

[Turn over



## 14. (continued)

**MARKS** DO NOT  
WRITE IN  
THIS  
MARGIN

(b) Sample data from the pupil table is shown below.

| Pupil    |            |                    |            |
|----------|------------|--------------------|------------|
| pupilRef | name       | address            | town       |
| PU1      | P Clifford | 21 Clark Street    | Kilmarnock |
| PU2      | N Price    | 76 Burnside Ave    | Greenock   |
| PU3      | M Flood    | 41 Sinclair Street | Greenock   |
| PU4      | A Singh    | 92 Rugby Road      | Kilmarnock |
| PU5      | J Wilson   | 8 Stadium Way      | Falkirk    |
| PU6      | M Ali      | 56 Lime Road       | Falkirk    |
| PU7      | S McGuire  | 18 Craigneuk Ave   | Airdrie    |
| PU8      | D McGregor | 120 Wallace Place  | Greenock   |
| ...      | ...        | ...                | ...        |

The driving school use the following SQL statement to display the number of pupils in each town.

```
SELECT town, COUNT(*) AS [Number Per Town]
FROM Pupil
GROUP BY town
ORDER BY COUNT(*) DESC, town ASC
```

- (i) Using the sample data provided, write the expected output from the SQL statement above.

2

| town | Number Per Town |
|------|-----------------|
|      |                 |

- (ii) The SQL statement above makes use of the `GROUP BY` command. Explain why the `GROUP BY` command is required in the SQL statement above to produce the expected output.

1

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\* X 8 1 6 7 6 0 1 2 4 \*



14. (continued)

(c) The data from the instructor table is shown below.

| Instructor   |             |           |            |
|--------------|-------------|-----------|------------|
| instructorID | name        | dayOff    | hourlyRate |
| 001          | C Robertson | Saturday  | 35         |
| 002          | L MacLean   | Sunday    | 40         |
| 003          | T Jack      | Wednesday | 35         |
| 004          | B Avidal    | Saturday  | 36         |
| 005          | F Shabnam   | Tuesday   | 36         |

The output below shows the average hourly rate of instructors who have their day off at the weekend.

| Average Hourly Rate |
|---------------------|
| 37                  |

Write the SQL statement that would produce the output above.

3

[Turn over



14. (continued)

- (d) The driving school would like to know the `pupilRef` of all the pupils who have lessons with the instructor who offers lessons at the cheapest hourly rate.

```
SELECT pupilRef
FROM Booking, Instructor
WHERE Booking.instructorID = Instructor.instructorID
AND hourlyRate = MIN(hourlyRate);
```

When tested the SQL statement did not execute because an aggregate function cannot be included in a `WHERE` clause in this way.

Describe one solution to this problem.

2

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[END OF SECTION 2]



**SECTION 3 — WEB DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT — 25 marks**

**Attempt ALL questions**

- 15.** A section of the CSS code for styling a website is shown below:

```
main {background-color: red;}
section {background-color: red; padding: 5px;}
p {padding: 5px;}
h1 {color: white; font-size: 22px; padding: 5px;}
h2 {padding: 5px;}
```

Use grouping selectors to re-write the code to make it more efficient.

**3**

[Turn over



16. Usability testing is carried out on a low fidelity prototype of a holiday website login page.

## My Account

LOG IN
REGISTER

Forename

Surname

Email address

Password

Password must have at least 10 characters

Create account

In order to register a user must enter their forename, surname, email address and a password.

Usability testing is carried out using personas, test cases and scenarios.

- (a) Describe what is meant by 'personas'. 1

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- (b) Describe two scenarios that can be used to carry out usability testing for this form. 2

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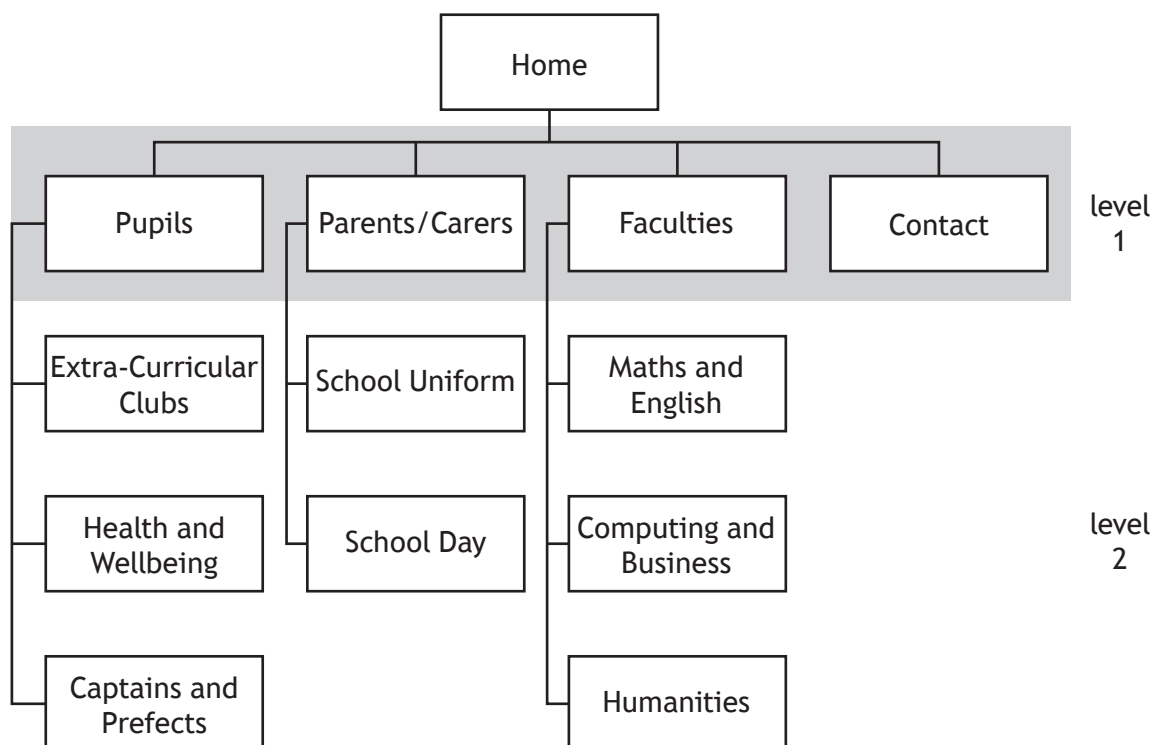
---



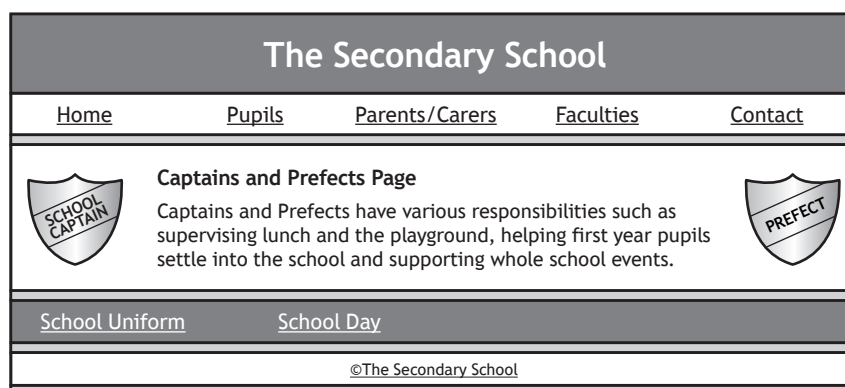
---



17. The following diagram shows the navigational structure of a secondary school website.



- (a) (i) The 'Captains and Prefects' web page has been created and is shown below. It does not match the navigational structure shown above.



Describe the difference between the navigational structure and the actual web page.

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17. (a) (continued)

(ii) Complete the CSS code to style the horizontal navigational bar so that:

- no bullet points are shown
- each list item is placed horizontally
- when the cursor is placed over an anchor element, the background colour is white and the text colour is black.

3

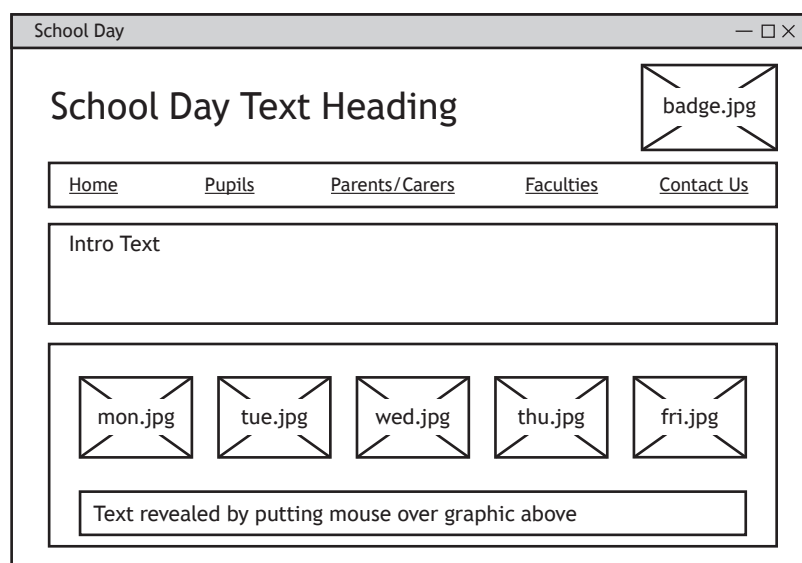
```
nav ul {_____ :none;}

nav ul li {_____;width:180px;}

nav ul li a {display:block;padding:6px;}

nav ul li _____ {background-color: white;
color: black;}
```

(b) The wireframe for the ‘School Day’ web page is shown below.



17. (b) (continued)

When the mouse is moved over the `mon.jpg` graphic, the Monday text should appear with information about Monday's school day. The `displayMon` JavaScript event executes this feature.

Part of the HTML code used for this web page is shown below.

```
...

...
<section id="monText" style="display:none">
    <h2>Monday</h2>
    <p>8.55am - 3.45pm</p>
</section>
...
```

- (i) The HTML code shown above is not fit for purpose.

Re-write the line of code to correct the error.

1

- (ii) The function `displayMon` calls another JavaScript function named `hideAllDays` which hides the text for all of the days currently displayed, ensuring only the text for Monday is displayed.

```
<script>

function hideAllDays() {
    document.getElementById("monText").style.display="none";
    ...
}

function displayMon() {
    _____A_____
    document.getElementById("monText").style.display="__B__";
}
</script>
```

Complete the missing JavaScript code for the function `displayMon`.

2

A \_\_\_\_\_

B \_\_\_\_\_



\* X 8 1 6 7 6 0 1 3 1 \*

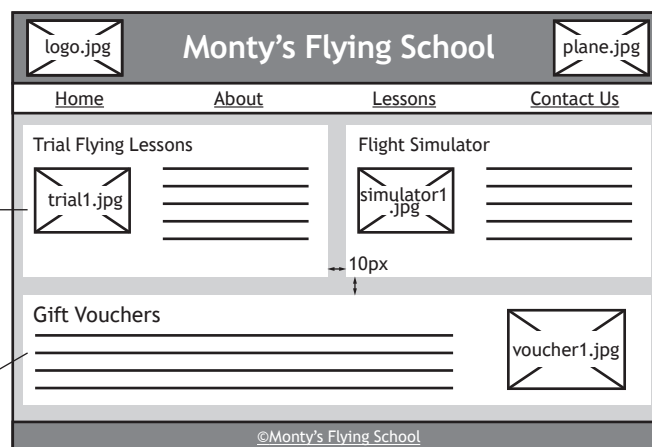
18. Monty's Flying School has a website to advertise their business.

(a) The wireframe for one of the web pages is shown below.

The 'Trial Flying Lessons' and the 'Flight Simulator' sections should be displayed side by side and the 'Gift Vouchers' section displayed underneath.

Each of these sections should be 385px × 200px in size and have a 10px gap between them.

This section should be 790px × 120px in size and have a 10px gap between it and the two sections above.



Complete the CSS code to allow all three sections to be displayed as shown in the wireframe.

3

```
#trialFlyingLessons, #flightSimulator {width : 385px ;
height : 200px; float:left;}

#flightSimulator {

}

#giftVouchers{

}

}
```





18. (continued)

- (b) (i) The 'Gift Vouchers' section includes a link to open a new web page which will allow users to enquire about gift vouchers for flying lessons.

The user must enter their name, contact telephone number, email, preferred location (Glasgow, Edinburgh or Prestwick airport) and a preferred date for the lesson.

Draw a wireframe for a form that would allow users to provide the information for a gift voucher.

3



[Turn over



18. (b) (continued)

- (ii) The HTML code used to create the input box to allow the user to enter their email is shown below.

Email\*`<input type="text" name="email" size="50">`

State the attributes that would need to be added to ensure that an email address of at least six characters must be entered.

2

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- (c) The CSS rule below is contained in an external stylesheet.

`footer p {font-size: 10px; }`

State the type of selector used in the code above and explain its effect.

2

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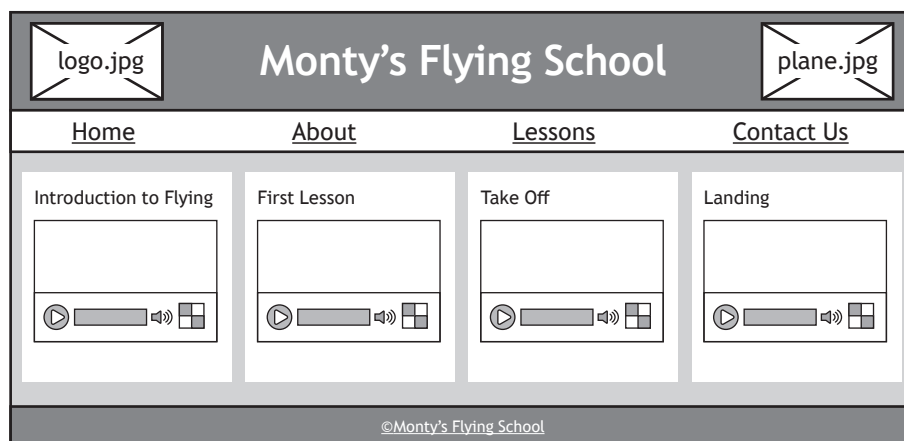


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18. (continued)

- (d) Another web page is to be created that will display video clips as shown in the wireframe below.



Describe two different compatibility tests that should be carried out on this web page.

2

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[END OF SECTION 3]

[END OF QUESTION PAPER]



ADDITIONAL SPACE FOR ANSWERS



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